

Reclaim

Find a next use for materials left after an event

The problem

After cleanups, college festivals and other events, organisers may have usable items or sorted recyclable material but no clear way to reach someone who wants them. Reclaim focuses on this handoff: helping an organiser list available material and connect with a nearby person, collector or recycler.

What we are building

A simple web marketplace for recovered materials. Organisers list items for free or at an asking price. People browse, search and filter listings, request an item, and agree on collection or delivery with the organiser. Paid transactions happen directly, such as cash at handover. The app does not process payments.

Core features

1. List materials after any event

Add a title, photos, category, quantity, condition, event name, approximate location, availability date and a free or priced offer. Clearly separate reusable items from material intended for recycling. Examples include usable boards, plant pots, cardboard and sorted plastic bottles.

2. Discover through search and categories

Browse available listings and filter by category, locality, reuse or recycling, and free or paid. A listing page shows the item details, organiser and collection terms. Start with a list view so the core experience does not depend on building a map.

3. Request items and agree on handover

A buyer or collector sends a request with the intended pickup time and contact details. The organiser accepts a request and reserves the listing. Collector pickup is the default. For a larger or higher-value batch, the parties can agree on organiser delivery and any transport cost. Delivery is optional and arranged directly.

4. Track availability and completion

Use three listing states: Available, Reserved and Collected. Organisers manage their listings and incoming requests. After handover, they mark the listing collected. If an arrangement falls through, they can make it available again. Collection records a transfer, not proof of recycling.

Example journey

After a college event, an organiser lists reusable wooden boards and sorted cardboard. A student group finds the boards by category and requests them. The organiser accepts, the group collects them and pays cash if a price was agreed. The listing is then marked collected.

Hackathon scope and build plan

Build accounts, listing creation with photo uploads, search and filters, a request form, an organiser view and status changes. Skip event hosting, group chat, maps, online payments and delivery tracking. Aim for the listing and discovery flow on October 10, then requests, handover status, deployment and the demo on October 11. Keep October 8 and 9 light around exams.

Track fit and demo

The proposed Waste and Energy fit is reuse and recycling. Demonstrate one complete exchange from listing to collection. Use AWS for a working part of the application, such as hosting and photo storage. The prototype should make it easy to see what is available, request it and arrange a handoff.